

LEADING THE WAY India Today Group Editorial Director (Publishing) Raj Chengappa (extreme left)

THE NEW PA

INDIA TODAY GROUP'S 'DRIVERS OF CHANGE' RECOGNISES 15 VISIONARIES WHOSE INNOVATION, ACTIVISM AND HERITAGE PRESERVATION ARE SHAPING THE FUTURE

By Suhani Singh / *Photographs by* MILIND SHELTE, MANDAR DEODHAR

An environmental activist preserving centuries-old root bridges in Meghalaya (Morningstar Khongthaw); a doctor (Shalini Mishra) who left her medical practice to work for cow protection; a mechanical engineer (Vimal Govind M.K. of Genrobotics) who has developed the world's first manhole-cleaning robot in a bid to eliminate manual scavenging and a social worker (Sudha Varghese) who moved to Bihar at age 16 to uplift the marginalised Musahar community. These were just some of the changemakers celebrated at the second edition of Drivers of Change. Organised by the India Today Group in collaboration with Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd, India's leading SUV manufacturer, the event held on March 17 in Mumbai recognised 15 individuals across India who through their work are ensuring that 'Swarnim Bharat: Virasat aur Vikas' becomes a reality.

Rajesh Jejurikar, executive director & CEO, auto & farm sector, Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd, highlighted how India is a nation which has embraced modernity and technology but done so "within the